[Metric]
A-A-2966
March 11, 1996

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION
MARKER, TUBE TYPE, CRAYON, HIGHLIGHTER
(ILLUMINATOR STX & REFILLS)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description by all federal agencies.

1. Scope: This commercial item description covers non-toxic refillable, crayon type markers for use in highlighting text.

2. Salient Characteristics:

2.1 The marker shall consist of a replaceable solid ink cartridge, holder (barrel) with a twist type mechanism for securing, propelling and repelling the cartridge, and a cap with pocket clip.

2.2 The barrel shall be made of plastic or metal or a combination of these materials and the cap shall be tight fitting to provide protection against evaporation.

2.3 The dispenser shall have a length of not less than 122 mm ± 2 mm (4.8 inches ± .078 inches) with the cap attached, and a diameter of 15 mm ± 2 mm (.59 inches ± .078 inches) measured at its largest diameter.

2.4 The ink cartridge shall contain a non-toxic, water based pigment ink which is odorless, quick drying, and shall not bleed through paper.

2.5 The manufacturer's name or trademark shall be exhibited on the marker. Placement of these permanent markings shall be at the option of the manufacturer, provided they are prominently displayed.

2.6 Refill cartridges shall consist of a cartridge with a plastic holding device attached. The writing end of the cartridge shall be beveled to prevent chipping. The cartridge shall be enclosed inside a plastic tube with cap to prevent evaporation of the ink. The cartridge and holding device shall be no greater than 50.7 mm ± 1 mm (1.99 inch ± .004 inch) in length. The plastic tube with cap attached shall not be greater than 53.7 mm ± 1 mm in length (2.1 inches ± .004 inch).

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc. and any data which may improve this document should be sent to General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, Engineering Branch, 26 Federal Plaza, New York, NY 10278.

FSC 7520

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2.7 Shelf Life. The markers shall have a shelf life of one year after delivery and shall be capable of withstanding normal usage and handling.

2.8 Workmanship. The markers shall be securely assembled so that parts do not become loose or displaced and shall be free from defects or imperfections which may affect appearance serviceability or performance.

3. Regulatory Requirements:

The offerer/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials to the maximum extent practicable, in accordance with paragraph 23.403 of the Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR).

4. Quality Assurance Requirements:

4.1 Contractor Certification. The contractor shall certify and maintain substantiating evidence that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this Commercial Item Description, and that the product conforms to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and therefore as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

4.2 Examination and Testing:

4.2.1 Suppliers are encouraged to use quality control (QC) techniques that exhibit control over their processes (e.g. (Statistical Process Control) SPC Techniques) as defined in American National Standards Institute (ANSI) Z1.1, Z1.2 and Z1.3 / American Society for Quality Control (ASQC) B.1, B.2 and B.3 that systematically reduce excess variations. If used, objective evidence shall be available that demonstrates overall measurement adequacy techniques and controls. These techniques shall ensure quality levels equal to, or greater than, those cited in applicable technical document or, herein.

4.2.2 End item inspection/testing may be used by the offerrer or the government representative, as a means to determine the effectiveness of the in process quality controls. While in process controls shall not be substituted for end item performance testing,they may be used for visual and dimensional sampling.

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4.2.3 For those characteristics for which there are no such controls, or for end item performance test, lot by lot sampling for inspection/test shall be required. The sample unit shall be one marker with fill cartridge. Sampling shall be in accordance with the American National Standards Institute (ANSI) / American Society for Quality Control (ASQC) Z1.4, Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

4.2.4 An inspection lot shall consist of all like items submitted for inspection at one time. The inspection level for visual & dimensional examination shall be S-3 with an AQL of 2.5 percent defective. The inspection level for performance testing shall be S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 percent defective. The supplier must provide objective evidence (tests and inspection records) that the presented material meets the requirements of the sampling plan as indicated above.

4.3 Performance Testing.

4.3.1 Breaking Strength. Extend the ink cartridge 4.5 mm (0.180 inch) from the point of the marker. The test shall be performed on an electronic scale equipped with horizontal platform upon which the test pressure shall be applied. The platform shall offer no resistance to the point moving across its surface. The test shall be performed while maintaining a 45° angle The marking, above the horizontal, between the marker and the platform of the scale. This test may be performed by holding the marker between the fingertips or by using a mechanical device to insure the 45° angle is maintained. Place the point of the marking medium upon the platform of the scale. Apply vertical pressure by pressing the marker down gradually and uniformly, avoiding variations and shock. The marking medium shall show an average breaking strength of not less than 550 grams with no single break of less than 500 grams when tested as specified. Readings shall be taken at the instant of breaking, provided the breaking point is definite. A slow, mushy deformation or crumbling shall not be considered as a break. The breaking strength shall be based on the average of all tests made. Three markers shall be used for this test and each shall be subjected to not less than two tests, one on each side of the marking medium.

4.3.2 Startability. Place three unused markers in a horizontal position on a flat surface with the caps removed. After 30 minutes, draw the marking medium across a sheet of plain bond paper until a continuous line is obtained. Marking shall begin within the first 100 mm,. Test paper shall be in accordance with A-A-2804A, type III white bond paper having a pH of 5.0 with a basis weight of 60 grams per square meter (16 pound, 17 x 22 - 500). A tolerance of 5% is allowable. Alternately, paper conforming to JCP-O-60 can be used as an alternate source.

5. Packaging:

5.1 Preservation, packing and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order

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encouraged to use recovered materials

6. Notes:

6.1 Source of Documents. Issues of the following documents in effect on the date of invitation for bids or request for proposal form a part of this document to the extent specified herein.

6.1.1 Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) may be obtained from the Superintendent of Documents, Government Printing Office, Washington. DC 20402.

6.1.2 Application for copies of (ANSI) Z1.1, Z1.2 and Z1.3 and (ASQC) B.1, B.2 and B.3 may be obtained from the American Society for Quality Control. PO Box 3005, 611 E. Wisconsin Avenue, Milwaukee, WI 53201-4606.

6.1.3 JCP Specifications may be obtained from Chief Paper Procurement Section, MMPP, US Government Printing Office, North Capital and H Street, NW, Washington DC 20401.

6.1.4 Federal Standards and Specifications may be obtained from the General Services Administration Specifications Section (3FBO-W) in Suite 8100 at 490 L'Enfant Plaza, SW Washington DC 20407.

6.2 National Stock Number Listing (NSN). The following is a list of Nsn's assigned which correspond to this CID. The list may not be indicative of all possible nsn's associated with the CID.

Marker, Tube Type

7520-01-386-2407
7520-01-386-2441

Refill, Marker

7510-01-390-0709

MILITARY INTERESTS:

NONE: DoD has no registered interest in revisions and amendments to this Commercial Item Description until further notice.

Preparing Activity:

GSA-FSS

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